The Paddywhacker

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BDT 2005 · Vilamoura · Featuring Knoxy & Ash

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Knoxy's Paddywhacker is probably the most famous golf club to have graced the tour. Anyone who has played a round with the big guy will be extremely familiar with it as it is utilised for all shots in all situations, as his caddy in Marrakech found out when Knoxy proceeded to instruct him to pull it out for virtually every shot from 110 to 220!



The Paddywhacker!!

Consequently, one of the great moments of every tour is always our collective anticipation of what is to come on Round III when Knoxy is forced to employ his driver for its annual outing!

In the early days of tour, Knoxy had a temperamental relationship with his golf clubs and it's fair to say he was not a prolific point-scorer. Nowadays, it would not come as a surprise to see Knoxy take down any member of the opposition, but when he drew Ash in the singles on BDT 2005 the Dogs could be forgiven for thinking the result was a foregone conclusion.....WRONG!!!! This was surely the Paddywhacker's finest hour.

The story of how Ash was taken down is best described by the man himself in a story he has penned entitled "Yippity Yip"! Enjoy!



ASH

"As I sit here on a Sunday night with the demons swirling after two heavy sessions, I had a little flash back to my worst day on tour.

Vilamoura 2005. The scene of the Dark Tour. I am captaining a Bloodhounds team whose tails were wagging in some very interesting ways off the course but unfortunately not on it. Despite having all of about three hours sleep a night and suffering demons of an entirely different nature, the Retrievers were somehow managing to play some half decent golf and were 5-3 up going into the final round singles at Vila Sol. It was widely accepted on both sides that I had been a terrible captain and got my pairings all wrong.



Unhappy Ravo Dog!

Ravo in particular was not happy with the situation.

On a personal level, I was nowhere near the hunt for the Green Jacket. The pressure of captaincy had clearly told and I was playing some of the worst golf of my life; most disturbingly of all, a new phenomenon had started to creep into my short game; the chipping yips....

A rather bizarre disease whereby I would get a very severe attack of the demons every time I had a wedge in my hands, which meant that I would either dribble the ball forward and take a large divot that occasionally went further than the ball, or thin the ball from the fringe into a bunker on the other side of the green. No matter how many practice chips went to within 2 feet on the practice green, every chip was suddenly turning into an ordeal, much to the amusement of my playing partners.

As a result I did not feel that I was the man to lead the Bloodhounds out in the final round singles. I therefore put myself out last, by which time it would probably all be over. As it happened, I was in luck. I had been drawn against Knoxy Dog, a game I couldn't possibly lose no matter how many chips I yipped.



Father Abraham!

Or so I thought...

As I stood on the first tee at Vila Sol shortly after seeing BT spank yet another drive 280 yards down the middle, the beer sweats started and the demons began to swirl. Four hours earlier, I had been stripping off to the tune of Father Abraham. Now I needed to somehow find my game head.

I somehow managed to go 2 up but as I headed to the 4th tee, everything suddenly started to go wrong. Very wrong. Having hacked my way down the fairway in similar fashion to Knoxy, I found myself on the green with a two-foot putt for a double bogey. Knoxy had scrambled a triple bogey but had a shot, so my double bogey putt was for a half. Backswing, demons, yip, missed putt. Back to 1 up.



Scene of the Demons!

The 10th or thereabouts was a par five. I had hit a couple of reasonable shots to just short of the pond guarding the green. Knoxy was virtually out of the hole and struggling to make an 8. A pitch over the pond onto the green would leave me the luxury of 3 putts for the hole. Backswing, demons, yip, water. Reload. Backswing, demons, yip, water. Concede hole. All square.

And so it went on until the 17th when I found myself 2 down staring down the barrels of defeat. I hadn't had a par since the 2nd and Knoxy's grin was getting bigger by the minute. BT, who was practically talking Knoxy through every shot, could hardly contain himself. I needed to get up and down to take it down the last.

The Ryder Cup was over but personal pride was still at stake. Could I really lose to Knoxy?

Backswing, double demons, yip, thin, bunker. Game over. It had happened. I had lost to the worst golfer ever to grace the Big Dogs Tour and my Bloodhounds team had been demolished 11-5.

Knoxy enjoyed his beers that night. NOT my finest hour."



Handing over the Ryder Cup



Knoxy Celebrating!